Tornado Tigers · Practice 5 · Game-day prep

Tue Dec 1 · 5:30-6:30 pm · Rockwell Elementary · Coaches Brett and Cameron

Before 5:30: Coaches arrive 5:20: pump balls, poly spots out, lower hoops to 8 ft if they crank, water bottles along one wall, same two groups of 4 (Brett and Cameron).

- [ ] **5:30** **Opening huddle**
  Kids in a half circle. Today's goal: learn defense and practice exactly what happens on game day. Remind: whistle means stop and hold the ball.
  Say: Here's what we're getting better at today
  Coaches: one leads, one keeps everyone listening

- [ ] **5:32** **Warm-up: Red light/green light > sprint and slide**
  Red light/green light with dribble. Then sprint to half court, defensive slide back. 3 times.
  Say: Slide, don't cross your feet
  Coaches: one calls it, one at the far end

- [ ] **5:40** **Rule of the week: game day**
  Walk through: jump ball to start, subs line up at half court every 5 minutes, halftime free throws, no score kept, high-fives after.
  Say: Everyone plays, everyone cheers
  Coaches: one explains, one demonstrates

- [ ] **5:42** **Skill 1: Defensive stance**
  Feet wider than shoulders, knees bent, hands out palms up, eyes on your player's belly button. Hold 5 seconds, 5 times.
  Say: Wide, low, hands out
  Coaches: demo together, then one coach per group

- [ ] **5:49** **Water**
  Balls on spots, walk to bottles.
  Coaches: one runs it, one sets up the next drill

- [ ] **5:51** **Skill 2: Sprint and slide**
  Sprint full court, open up, slide back to the other side. Groups go one after another.
  Say: Low and wide the whole way
  Coaches: demo together, then one coach per group

- [ ] **5:58** **Skill 3: Home base**
  After a coach's shot, coach yells "Home base!" Everyone sprints back to our basket and gets in stance.
  Say: Home base means run back
  Coaches: demo together, then one coach per group

- [ ] **6:05** **Water + rules check**
  Pinnies on. Before we play, players say the rules back: no stealing from a dribbler; no swatting shots; guard your color; subs line up at half court; jump ball starts the game; high-fives after.
  Say: Tell me the rules before we play
  Coaches: one runs it, one sets up the next drill

- [ ] **6:07** **Scrimmage: game rehearsal**
  Jump ball, play 5 minutes, practice a sub at half court, play 3 more minutes, then everyone takes a halftime free throw.
  Say: Subs ready at half court
  Coaches: one refs, one coaches

- [ ] **6:16** **Closing huddle**
  Did we hit today's goal? Thumbs up. Ask one or two kids what they liked. Try at home: talk about Saturday: everyone plays, and we cheer for both teams. Team cheer.
  Say: Then raise hoops, sweep, hand off to parents
  Coaches: one leads, one keeps everyone listening